

PROJECT “ME”: A Strategic Transition from Active Entrepreneurship to a Flexible, Experience-Driven Lifestyle with Financial Independence

Author: Dr Jana Fiserova

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Executive Summary

This dissertation explores the strategic transition from active entrepreneurship to a diversified, flexible career model that integrates financial independence, professional reinvention, and global mobility. Using my own transition as a case study – exiting Family Bakery and shifting toward property investment, digital entrepreneurship, and consultancy – the research presents a structured framework for entrepreneurs seeking to redefine their careers while maintaining financial stability.

Key Research Objectives

The study is guided by three primary objectives:

1. **Understanding the Entrepreneurial Exit Process** – Analyzing the financial, emotional, and strategic considerations of transitioning out of business ownership.
2. **Developing Sustainable Income Streams** – Evaluating property investment, digital asset development, and consultancy as viable revenue sources.
3. **Leveraging Global Travel for Career Growth** – Examining how international experiences can contribute to professional reinvention and financial independence.

Theoretical Framework and Literature Review

The research builds upon career transition theories, psychological adaptation models, and entrepreneurial exit strategies. Bridges’ Transition Model, Schlossberg’s Transition Theory, and the Kaleidoscope Career Model provide insights into the emotional and identity shifts that accompany career reinvention. Psychological frameworks such as the Kubler-Ross Change Curve and Ibarra’s Identity-Based Career Transition Model offer a structured understanding of the challenges entrepreneurs face when redefining their professional identities. Gender-specific career transition models, including the MAP Coaching Model and the 5-Step Framework for Women’s Life Transitions, highlight how women’s career trajectories often evolve based on shifting priorities.

Analytical Findings

The study’s analytical section examines the financial and strategic dimensions of transitioning from active business ownership to a more diversified career model:

- **Entrepreneurial Exit Strategies** – A detailed assessment of Family Bakery's closure, including financial settlements, emotional impact, and lessons learned from the process.
- **Investment and Passive Income Models** – A feasibility study of property investments, digital assets, and consultancy services, demonstrating the potential for long-term financial stability.
- **Personal Development and Global Perspective** – Analyzing how structured travel can contribute to career reinvention by providing networking opportunities, learning experiences, and exposure to new business ecosystems.
- **Lessons from Other Entrepreneurs** – Case studies of professionals who successfully transitioned from traditional business ownership to investment, digital entrepreneurship, and consulting, illustrating best practices for career reinvention.

Proposal for Career Transition

A structured roadmap is developed to guide the transition from business ownership to financial independence:

1. **Strategic Transition Framework** – A phased approach including business exit preparation, financial reinvestment, and professional repositioning.
2. **Investment and Financial Planning** – A clear strategy for property acquisitions, income diversification, and financial projections over a three-year period.
3. **Personal and Professional Development Strategy** – A global travel itinerary aligned with business objectives, skill development, and professional networking.

Recommendations for Implementation

This dissertation provides practical guidelines for executing a structured career transition:

- **Business Exit Planning** – Step-by-step strategies for managing financial, legal, and operational aspects of business closure.
- **Investment Strategies** – Guidelines for selecting and managing passive income sources, including property rentals, digital assets, and consultancy.
- **Maximizing Global Travel for Career Growth** – Recommendations for leveraging travel to enhance professional development, maintain career engagement, and explore new business opportunities.

Conclusion

Career reinvention is not a singular event but an iterative process requiring strategic foresight, financial preparedness, and adaptability. By integrating structured business exit strategies, diversified income streams, and global learning experiences, entrepreneurs can successfully transition into sustainable, location-independent careers. The findings of this dissertation contribute to both academic and practical discussions on entrepreneurial career transitions, offering a comprehensive roadmap for professionals seeking financial independence and professional fulfillment beyond traditional business ownership.